

Partnership for Action on Green Economy (PAGE)

CONCEPT NOTE

Green Economy Week

26th -28th November 2025

UBUMWE GRANDES HOTEL-KIGALI

Rwanda CHAPTER



Introduction

Partnership for Action on Green Economy (PAGE) is a global program that supports countries to provide policy and strategic orientation on the integration of the green economy principles into the development mainstream of countries' economic and social transformation. PAGE Rwanda started in 2022 as a project to support other national development objectives that are green and climate resilient and foster national level plans to respond to the global green economy challenges. PAGE is implemented by five UN agencies (UNITAR, UNIDO, ILO, UN-Environment and UNDP) and works closely with Government through Ministry of Finance and Economic Planning (MINECOFIN) and the Ministry of Environment (MoE).

Green economy approaches to development is very critical for Rwanda since it is a natural resource-based economy, and its development is hinged solely on environment and Natural resources for the livelihood of its people. This is well viewed from various range of sectors that use and benefit directly from Natural resources including but are not limited to agriculture, tourism and mining. Forestry and water resources have immensely contributed to the Rwanda's economy through internal financial resources generation as well as contributing to other health and ecosystem benefits at large.

As envisioned in the medium-term strategy for Transformation (NST-2), Rwanda's vision (Vision 2050) as well as the National Long-term strategy for climate change (Green growth and climate resilience strategy) green growth development path is one of the strategies required to realise the safety of environment and natural resources as well as the will to turn climate change setbacks into climate resilient opportunities and actions. This does not only consider the internal agreed-upon interventions but also considers and aspires to achieve globally agreed-upon goals and targets, including the Sustainable Development Goals (SDG), and to comply with the provisions and commitments of international and regional conventions and instruments. The international policy context indeed requires and supports the integration and implementation of environmental and natural resource management, resilience building and mitigation objectives in national development policies and programmes.

Rwanda has moved ahead to develop other sectoral strategies considering the sustainability elements into them. These include among others the agricultural policy, National land use and development masterplan, the transport policy as well as the environment and climate change policy and national investment policy. Instruments like green taxonomy, climate and nature finance strategy have been introduced to support resource mobilization at speed and scale required from and for both public and private sector investments. At the district level, environment and climate resilient actions have also been included in the district development strategies (DDSs), local economic development strategies as well as conducting feasibility studies including Environment impact assessment (EIA) to all private and public investments at the sectoral and district levels of administration. At the policy level, Strategic environmental assessments (SEA) have also been prioritised. So far, sectors of agriculture, energy, mining and urbanization have already conducted the SEA for sustainable policy/strategic orientation and guidance. Rwanda has made very significant progress in the integration of environment and

climate change (E&CC) into plans and supported to increase budget allocation through Climate Budget Tagging (CBT) to green and climate proof different investments at the sectoral, district and community level.

To support this process and as was enshrined in the PAGE stock taking study, key six (6) areas were identified as entry points for Rwanda to effectively implement green economy. These areas include i) **align all development strategies, plans, and initiatives with the country's IGE principles and goals**, ii) **Enhance green knowledge and skills development programs for students, entrepreneurs, policymakers, and workers in the public and private domains**, iii) **Help increase access to capital resources in the country and overcome the lack of finance, for example through a Green Fiscal Reform and the Green Taxonomy**, iv) **Promote green development through community-based and localized interventions**, v) **Promotion of small-scale green income generating projects**, vi) **Promotion of green development through increased emergency management and preparedness**.

This concept paper therefore is developed to facilitate Rwanda and PAGE UN agencies to prepare and organize green economy week that is scheduled to take place from 26th -28th November 2025 at Ubumwe Grandes Hotel-Kigali.

Rationale for Green Economy Week

Green economy week will be organized in form of a workshop and where possible remote participation will be thought about to facilitate many participants to attend and contribute to different discussions and presentations on green economy in Rwanda and across the globe. It is also important occasion for Rwanda to make a case on the progress so far made and learn from what is taking place elsewhere to bridge the current existing policy/strategic and green economy financing gaps.

There are several regional initiatives on green economy whose experience and lessons learnt will be a benchmark for Rwanda's PAGE. These include African Green Economy Partnership (AGEP) that promotes inclusive green growth and sustainable development through policy harmonization and investment mobilization. African Union (AU) Agenda 2063 which Prioritizes green and inclusive growth under aspirations for a prosperous Africa based on sustainable development. Last but not least the African Development Bank (AfDB) – Green Growth Framework: Supports member countries in transitioning to green economies, focusing on renewable energy, natural capital, and resilience. With these regional initiatives and experience sharing with different knowledgeable participants, Rwanda will also benefit from the expertise and knowledge on sustainable use of the environment, including natural resources and biodiversity, and how will Rwanda maintain and increase the social and economic benefits generated as well as resilience in the face of climate change, and contribute to mitigation. This will have a long-term effect on achievement of key economic development goals such as food security, energy access and poverty reduction. For example, investing in soil erosion control boosts agricultural productivity, food production and rural incomes.

UN PAGE implementing institutions will get an opportunity to show case their support to Rwanda and what Rwanda can learn from other countries implementing PAGE and Green economy at large.

Objectives of the green economy week

- Raising awareness, promoting sustainable practices, fostering collaboration among stakeholders, identifying opportunities for green growth, and supporting the transition to a low-carbon and environmentally sound economy Discussion on the role of public and private sector in advancing green economy.
- Discussion of new opportunities, challenges and tools for sustainable development of private sector.
- Understanding green measures, policies, technologies, resources and other green decisions for stakeholders.

Participants

Participants will include:

- Government delegates across government institutions
- Parliament of Rwanda representatives
- UN PAGE agencies and UN PAGE funders
- Private sector
- Civil society organizations
- Academia
- International and development organizations

Time	Session	Lead
Day 1: Wednesday 26th of November		
9.00-9.45	Registration + Coffee	All
9.45-10.15	Opening session: workshop objectives and agenda	Rwanda PAGE Coordinator (Moderator)
	Opening remarks	UN Resident Coordinator Resident Representative (UNDP) PAGE Funding Partner Hon. Minister (MoE)
10:15-10:25	Group photo	UNDP/MEDIA
Theme 1: Green economy development		
10:25-10:35	Video Message from UN Secretary-General António Guterres	UN RCO
10:35-10:55	Presentation on PAGE	PAGE Management Board
10:55-11:05	A video documentary highlighting Rwanda's success stories on the green growth agenda. (5 mins)	MoE
11:05-12:00	Roundtable Discussion: Scaling Green Growth Agenda — Policies, Investments, and Partnerships. Theme: Advancing Green and Climate-Resilient Development for Sustainable Economic Growth Audience Q&A	Moderator: Jaime Garron Bozo (RC's office) Panelists: UNDP, ILO, UNIDO and MoE

12:00-12:30	Implementation of green economy through gender responsive and just transition	ILO
12:30-1:00	Mainstreaming green economy approaches into education sector	UNITAR/HEC
13:00-14:00	Lunch	
14:00-14:30	Q&A	
14:30-15:00	Role of research to foster green economy implementation	IGE Rwanda/University of Rwanda
Theme 2: Green economy Investment		
15:00-15:30	Analysis of Rwanda's fiscal, legal, and regulatory frameworks to mobilize and scale up investments in nature-based infrastructure solutions	UNEP
15:30-16:00	Investment in Geospatial Technology for sustainable Land use and green economy development	NLA
16:00-16:15	Coffee and Tea Break	All
16:15-16:30	Implementation of green economy approaches at the community level	ARCOS Network
16:30-17:00	Q&A	Moderator
Day 2: Thursday 27th of November		
9:30-10:00	Summary Day 1 + coffee	UNDP/MoE
10:00-10:30	Green economy implementation: Urbanisation: Case of green city pilot	Rwanda Green FUND

Theme 3: Green Economy Financing		
10:30-11:00	Circular economy scenarios, financing, technology needs and justifications for adopting circular economy and resource efficiency measures for meeting climate action goals.	UNIDO/NIRDA-CPCIC
11:00-11:20	Q&A	UNDP/Moderator
11:20-11:50	Green solutions for business	Private Sector Federation (PSF)
11:50-12:20	Presentation on Green Taxonomy for private sector investment	MINECOFIN
12:20-12:40	Programmatic Investment- A leeway for Rwanda's Public and Private Investment	MoE/MINECOFIN
12:40-13:00	Biodiversity financing	UNDP
13:00-14:00	Lunch	
14:00-14:30	Q&A	UNDP/Moderator
14:30-15:00	Greening PFM	MINECOFIN/AFD
15:00-15:30	Tracking climate resilience expenditures (Climate Budget)	MINECOFIN
15:30-15:50	Q&A	UNDP/Moderator
15:50-16:20	Coffee	All
16:20-16:40	Announcements on the Trip (Bugesera)	UNDP/Moderator
Day 3: Friday 28th of November		
9.00-9.30	Field visit (Electric waste)	Enviroserve Rwanda (Bugesera district)

Note: Weblinks for PAGE

<https://www.un-page.org/>

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